

Verdict

It's easy to find fault with Dark Souls II but it's hard to blame the team behind it. They've worked really hard to create a great game, but without the direction of its original director, the game lost out on the very charm that made it special.

This still a great game and still one that you shouldn't miss, but only if you've played the original first.

MOAR!

- » **Genre:** Action RPG
- » **Developer:** From Software
- » **Publisher:** Namco Bandai
- » **Price:** ₹3,000 (Steam)



daredevil explorer who's stumbled into the ruins of an ancient world where ghosts of the past still linger (Old Dragonslayer, we're looking at you) and it just feels wrong. The world is too dead.

That's the problem with Dark Souls II, it depends too much on your past memories to make the game seem great. It doesn't have a soul of its own. The game improves on Dark Souls' combat, refines the graphics, tries to tell a better, more interesting story and it does do all of that. However, it does all of the above without that sense of style and without the atmosphere of the previous game. There was a sort of dark dignity to the characters of Dark Souls, a dignity that you still find in many of the bosses in this sequel, but it's a dignity that is missing from the rest of the world. The creatures in Dark

Souls II are just monsters, automatons with no soul of their own, no different from the dozens of nameless beasts you'd find in games like Diablo III.

A game with good mechanics is just a game with good mechanics; it's something that lacks character, a soul. Dark Souls II is a game with great mechanics and thus, a great game; the best we've played this year and we're fairly certain that we'll sink a few hundred hours into this one. But Dark Souls II will never leave as indelible a mark as Dark Souls. That said, Dark Souls II is still such an incredible game that given a choice, we'd pick the sequel over the original any day, but that's only because we've already experienced the joy, the wonder and the despair of the original and once you get past that, it's still the gameplay that counts. *

